

Academic Writing (BETA)

Seminar 7



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Today's programme

- ▶ **Formality**
 - ▶ Exercise
- ▶ **Referencing style (recap)**
- ▶ **Essay structure**
 - ▶ Exercise
- ▶ **Assignment 4 instructions and Q&A**





Formality



Formality exercise (I)

On the handout is a paragraph from a student essay (a). Consider the formality and style of the text:

1. Underline any informal features of the text.
2. Suggest more formal alternatives.



Formality

On the other hand, the Internet of Everything (IoE) creates lots of opportunities. In this era people easily get their needed information and local business can improve their turnover by making more advertisements. Not the advertisement that you see in a newspaper, but the one that you will see on smart screens. This has been applied in New York, but they have the ambition to apply the smart screens also in Amsterdam, Berlin and Paris. Most people will say that the smart screen does not add any value, because most people make use of a smartphone and it's possible to get all your information you need from your device. Have they never thought of tourists who have never been in a major city like New York and would like to drink a coffee at a Starbucks store? No. That is why the smart screen is such a good idea. This shows that our data can benefit our society in lots of ways and create more opportunities.



Formality exercise (2)

- ▶ **On the handout is a modified version (b) of the original paragraph. This was produced by ChatGPT after it was prompted to increase the formality of the text. Compare the original paragraph (a), the modified paragraph (b) and your own suggestions:**

1. What are the main differences? Do you think some options are preferable to others?
2. Finalise a list of 'informal text features'



Formality increased by ChatGPT

On the contrary, the Internet of Everything (IoE) engenders a plethora of opportunities. Within this contemporary epoch, individuals effortlessly access the information they require, while local businesses enhance their revenue streams through intensified advertising endeavors. However, this advertising does not manifest itself through traditional print media, but rather through the medium of intelligent screens. The implementation of such screens has already been realized in New York, and the proponents of this technology aspire to extend its reach to other cosmopolitan hubs such as Amsterdam, Berlin, and Paris. Detractors often contend that smart screens fail to confer any discernible value, given the widespread usage of smartphones and their capacity to furnish all necessary information. Nevertheless, they tend to overlook the needs of unacquainted tourists who find themselves in unfamiliar urban locales, such as New York, and yearn for the prospect of patronizing a Starbucks establishment, for instance. It is precisely in catering to such unmet demands that the smart screen assumes a laudable notion. This exemplifies how leveraging our data can substantively contribute to the betterment of society and foster a host of novel opportunities.



Formality increased even further by ChatGPT

- ▶ On the contrary, the advent of the Internet of Everything (IoE) has ushered in a myriad of promising prospects. In this contemporary era, denizens effortlessly access the requisite information, while local enterprises augment their turnover through the judicious implementation of heightened promotional campaigns. Notably, this advertising modality diverges from the conventional print medium, instead relying on the integration of intelligent screens. Its successful deployment has already been witnessed in the urban landscape of New York, with an ambitious vision to extend this technological innovation to other prominent metropolises, including Amsterdam, Berlin, and Paris. Detractors frequently assert that smart screens lack inherent value, as the ubiquitous adoption of smartphones enables users to satisfy their informational needs comprehensively. However, such detractors inadvertently disregard the distinct requirements of uninitiated tourists traversing unfamiliar urban environs, such as New York, who seek to partake in the simple pleasure of patronizing a ubiquitous Starbucks establishment, for instance. Consequently, it is the astute implementation of these intelligent screens that conveys an indisputably commendable notion. Such an exemplification illuminates the manifold ways in which leveraging our collective data can substantively contribute to societal advancement and engender a panoply of novel opportunity.



Informal text features in paragraph (a)

- ▶ Vague and informal word choices (e.g. “get”, “lots of”, “say”)
- ▶ Verb contractions (e.g. “it’s”)
- ▶ Sentence fragments (e.g. “Not the advertisement that...”, “No.”)
- ▶ Asking and answering a rhetorical question (e.g. “Have they never thought....?”
“No.”)
- ▶ Second person pronouns (e.g. “you”, “your”)





Referencing style



Use **Harvard** or **IEEE** as referencing style

- ▶ Make sure you pay close attention to the following three aspects:
 - ▶ refer to the texts in the right format and right place in the text itself
 - ▶ include the full publication details in the bibliography of all articles mentioned in the text
 - ▶ be consistent in referencing throughout the text
- ▶ For Harvard, see <https://www5.open.ac.uk/library/referencing-and-plagiarism/quick-guide-to-harvard-referencing-cite-them-right>
- ▶ For IEEE, see <http://pitt.libguides.com/citationhelp/ieee>
- ▶ Of course: use proper paraphrasing! (i.e., “your own words”)





Essay structure



Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

Body

Conclusion



Introduction

RFID: privacy problems and solutions

Nowadays, it is possible to give humans, objects or animals a digital identity by using identity technology. Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) is an example of identity technology and was first used in military aircraft during the Second World War [1]. Radio Frequency Identification provides a tag with a unique serial number that can be attached to objects and injected into people or animals. This tag could be a label or a chip. The tag stores information about the person, animal or object to which it is attached to and is constantly communicating this information with the environment [1,2]. With the help of this feature, it is possible to request and save actual information about the tag carrier. This information can be used for a great amount of useful pervasive computing applications, such as highway toll collection and animal tracking. However, RFID also has the potential to violate the privacy of the carrier of the tag. That is because of the fact that a unique ID of a tag can easily be associated with the identity of a person. A Harris poll among the population of the United States showed that approximately 90% of the people are concerned about their privacy [2]. This paper will focus on the privacy concerns of RFID and on possible solutions for these concerns.



RFID: privacy problems and solutions

Observation (current trend/development)

Nowadays, it is possible to give humans, objects or animals a digital identity by using identity technology. Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) is an example of identity technology and was first used in military aircraft during the Second World War [1]. Radio Frequency Identification provides a tag with a unique serial number that can be attached to objects and injected into people or animals. This tag could be a label or a chip. The tag stores information about the person, animal or object to which it is attached to and is constantly communicating this information with the environment [1,2]. With the help of this feature, it is possible to request and save actual information about the tag carrier. This information can be used for a great amount of useful pervasive computing applications, such as highway toll collection and animal tracking. **However, RFID also has the potential to violate the privacy of the carrier of the tag.** That is because of the fact that a unique ID of a tag can easily be associated with the identity of a person. A Harris poll among the population of the United States showed that approximately 90% of the people are concerned about their privacy [2]. **This paper will focus on the privacy concerns of RFID and on possible solutions for these concerns.**

Problem: issues with privacy

Thesis statement

Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

Body

Conclusion



Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

Body

Conclusion

-
-
-



Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

Body

Conclusion

- Recap of thesis statement
- Answer
- Implications or further research

Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

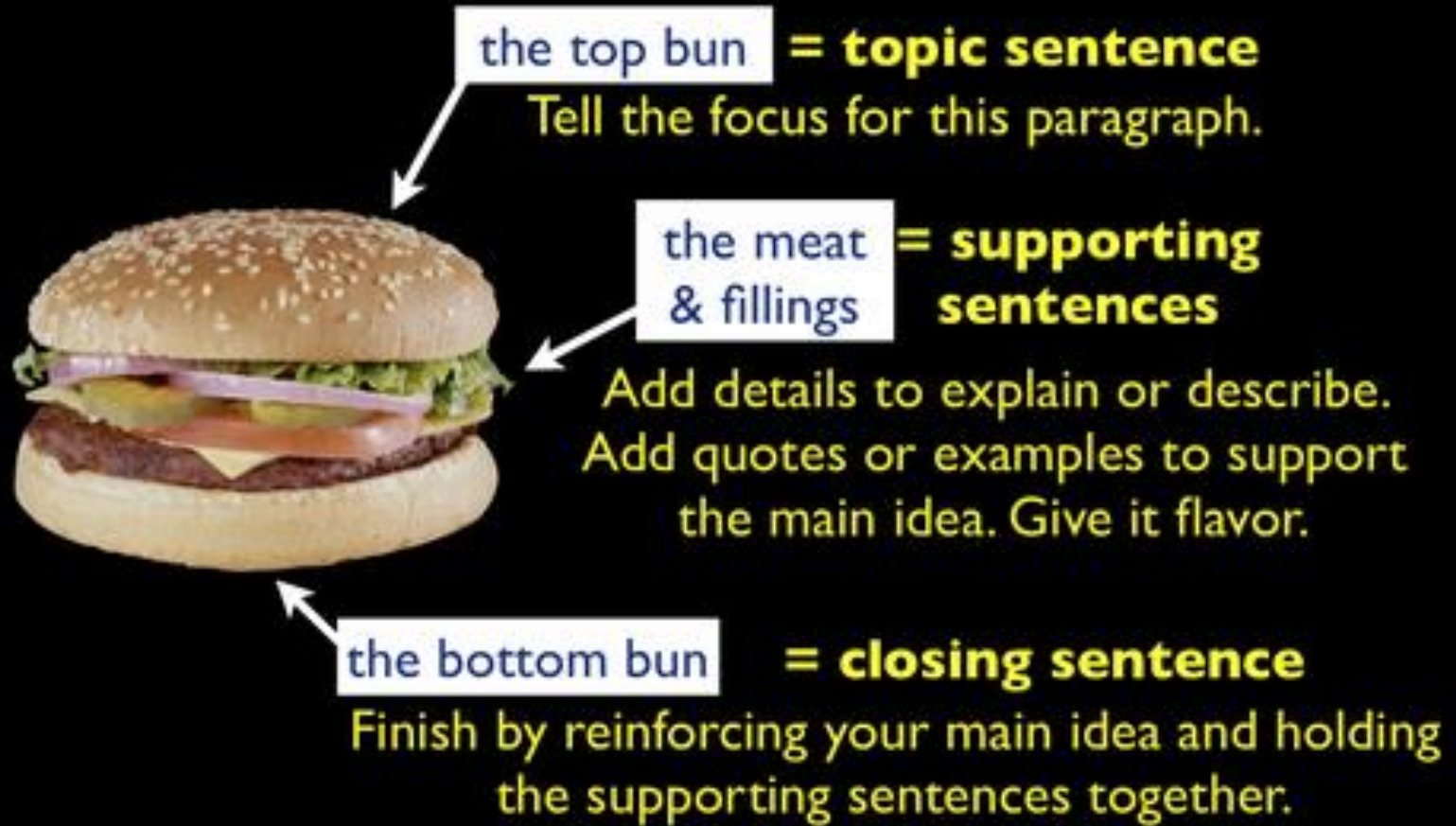
Body

-
-
-

Conclusion

- Recap of thesis statement
- Answer
- Implications or further research

The “Hamburger” Paragraph Model (A cheesy metaphor)



Title

Introduction

- Background
- Relevance
- Thesis statement

Body

- Topic sentence
- Elaboration
- Rounding off

Conclusion

- Recap of thesis statement
- Answer
- Implications or further research

Introduction: Thesis / Question

Body Paragraph: Comparative Point #1 (a similarity, difference, or other distinction between your two articles)

Body Paragraph: Comparative Point #2

Body Paragraph: Comparative Point #3

Conclusion: Return to the Thesis / Question



Evaluating essay structure

Evaluate this paper based on its outline

This paper will compare two articles discussing AI security and how two different studies dealt with these problems to answer the question whether Petri-nets could be the new language for biologists to share their knowledge.

The first challenge is to find the right balance between quantitative and qualitative modeling.

The second challenge is to develop a uniform way to graphically display Petri-nets, such that no background knowledge is required to interpret the network correctly.

The third challenge is to model Petri-nets which can handle both synchronous and asynchronous behavior.

So far, no one has been able to translate the information of a biological system into a network in a way Lazebnik (2002) proposed.

Evaluate this paper based on its outline

Determining the actual success of OSS within commercial organizations has been the subject of various articles and research over the years. Unfortunately, the findings are frequently contradictory and may have even exacerbated that uncertainty (Ven, Verhelst & Mannaert, 2008).

When asked, decision-makers often regard OSS to be inapplicable to their organizations, and thus pay little attention to it (Goode, 2004).

Another concern is the perceived lack of technical support (Goode, 2004).

Lastly, organizations often argue that they cannot adopt OSS because their existing software is incompatible with software from other vendors, which is often referred to as “vendor lock-in” (Ven, Verhelst & Mannaert, 2008).

Despite the thriving community of open-source software, the perception persists that OSS is not interesting for businesses.



Question	Answer should be in this part of your essay
1. What are you writing about?	Introduction
2. Why is this topic relevant/interesting?	Introduction
3. What question do you want to answer?	Should be translated into a thesis statement
4. What is the answer, or what kind of answer do you expect?	Introduction (thesis statement) and/or conclusion
5. What pieces of evidence do you have for your answer?	Each piece of evidence translates to a body paragraph
6. What are the implications of your answer?	Conclusion

Exercise 2: Creating a text plan

CORPUS RESEARCH - CONSENT



Research on language and writing development.

Use real student texts for teaching and research.

Study writing styles across disciplines, level and language background.

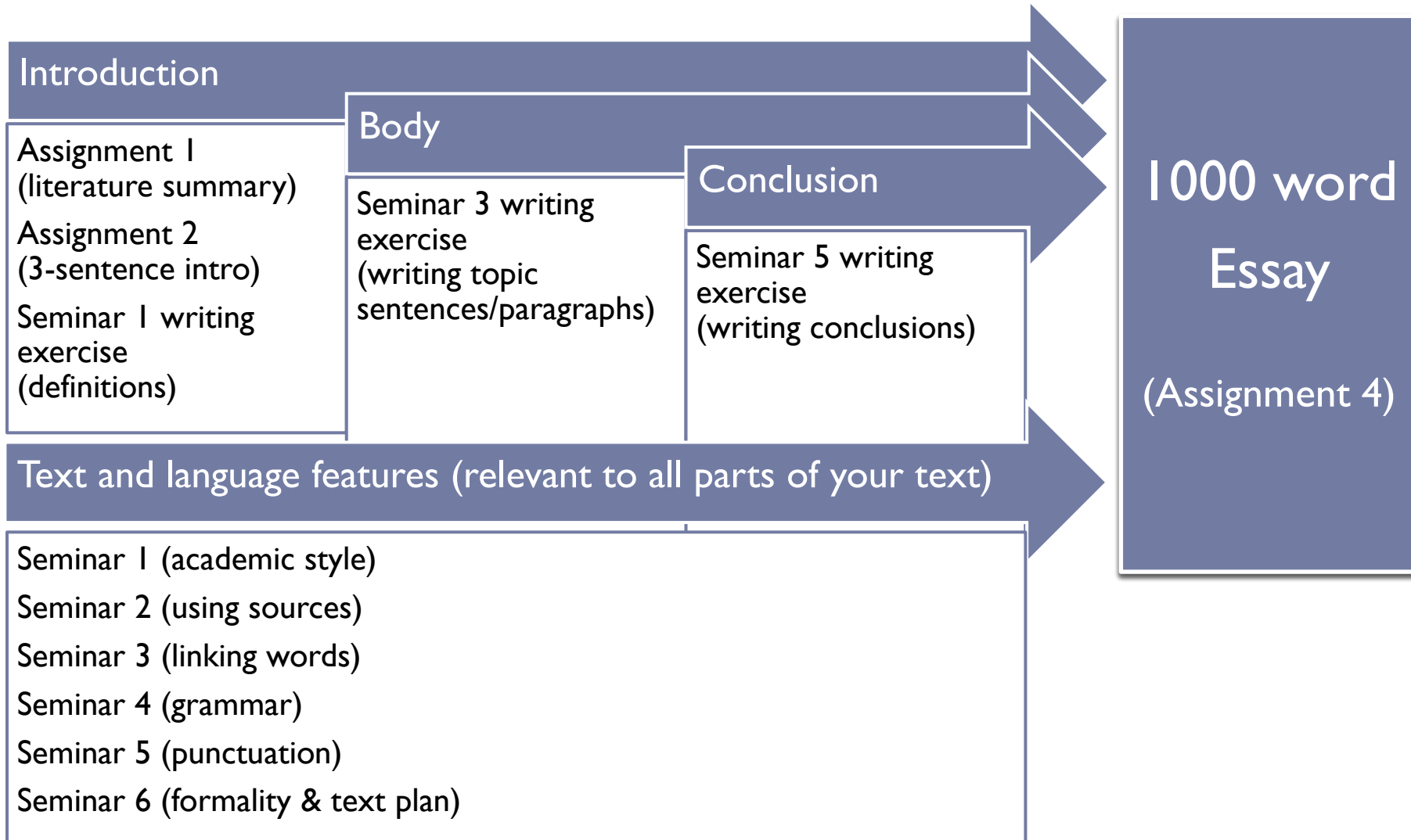
Participation is voluntary and anonymous.

Data stored securely and confidentially.

GDPR rights to access and correct data.

Instructions for assignment 4 (see Canvas)

The road to a 1000-word essay: putting all the parts of the course together



Assignment 4

▶ General instructions

- Write a 1000-word essay (plus or minus 10%) on a topic of your own choice related to your academic discipline. The aim of the final assignment is to see how you've developed your ideas into a full essay, and to see how the structure, quoting and referring conventions, academic style, clarity and accuracy of your writing have progressed, including whether you took feedback from the first three assignments on board.
 - Use two to five academic articles, either of your own choosing or from the database found on Canvas.
 - Hand in your assignment on Canvas (there will be a link under the Graded assignments module and under the Assignments tab)
 - Submissions by e-mail will not be accepted.
 - Late submissions will not be graded and you will have to wait until the resit date (to be announced).
 - The deadline is **23 May**, by the end of the day.
-



To do

Go through the instructions for the assignment on Canvas and check that the your text meets those requirements and that you understand what your text will be graded on.

Have a good look at the feedback on any earlier assignments in the course and make sure that you incorporate that feedback into this final assignment.

Make sure you proofread your text carefully for typos, grammar and vocabulary errors, and obvious formality errors such as ‘you’ and verb contractions.

Go through the items on the following checklist to make sure your document meets all requirements.



Checklist

- 1) Your name and student number are on the first page.
 - 2) The first page contains the title of your text.
 - 3) The text doesn't have any section headings.
 - 4) The text has a length of 1,000 words (+/- 10% not including bibliography).
 - 5) The text has the required paragraph structure:
 - *Every paragraph has a topic sentence, followed by the elaboration.*
 - *All paragraphs have roughly the same length (i.e. no one-sentence paragraphs, no subparagraphs).*
 - *The introduction is one paragraph.*
 - *The final sentence of the introduction contains the thesis statement, which may also take the form of a question (or statement of your aims, or research question).*
 - *The conclusion is one paragraph.*
-



Checklist

- 6) You have used the required number of academic sources.
- 7) You have indicated the sources correctly and consistently throughout the text, using an appropriate referencing style.
- 8) You have included a full bibliography.
- 9) The layout settings meet the following requirements:
 - *Use 1.5 spacing and standard font type and size.*
 - *Indent each paragraph, except the first one.*
 - *Don't use any extra line spaces between paragraphs (see point 12 below for details).*
 - *Keep the layout of the document as basic as possible (standard margins, standard font, no colours)*



Checklist

- 10) Your assignment can be handed in as a word document (NOT pdf, odt, ...).
- 11) If the Word version you are using has a standard extra space/white line after paragraphs, you need to remove this so that the space between lines between two paragraphs is identical to the space between lines within a paragraph. You can change this setting as shown in the following picture (next slide).



